

# Class 8: Unsupervised Learning Analysis of Human Breast Cancer Cells

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## Overview

This mini-project uses unsupervised learning (PCA + hierarchical clustering) on the Wisconsin Breast Cancer Diagnostic Data Set. Features describe cell nuclei from fine needle aspiration (FNA) biopsies of breast masses, with each sample labeled by a pathologist as **M** (malignant) or **B** (benign). We will *not* use that label for clustering, only to evaluate our unsupervised results at the end.

### Headline results:

- The dataset has 569 patients with 30 cell-nucleus measurements each; 212 are malignant.
- PC1 alone captures 44.3% of the total variance; 7 PCs are needed to reach 90%.
- `concave.points_mean`, `concavity_mean`, and compactness measures contribute most to PC1.
- Clustering on the first 7 PCs with `ward.D2` linkage separates malignant from benign samples much more cleanly than clustering on the raw 30 scaled features (**sensitivity 0.89, specificity 0.92**).
- Projecting two new patients onto this PCA space, **patient 1 should be prioritized for follow-up**, they land in the malignant-dominated region of PC1 vs PC2.

## Exploratory data analysis

### Preparing the data

```
fna.data <- "WisconsinCancer.csv"
wisc.df <- read.csv(fna.data, row.names=1)
head(wisc.df, 4)
```

|          | diagnosis               | radius_mean            | texture_mean     | perimeter_mean      | area_mean         |
|----------|-------------------------|------------------------|------------------|---------------------|-------------------|
| 842302   | M                       | 17.99                  | 10.38            | 122.80              | 1001.0            |
| 842517   | M                       | 20.57                  | 17.77            | 132.90              | 1326.0            |
| 84300903 | M                       | 19.69                  | 21.25            | 130.00              | 1203.0            |
| 84348301 | M                       | 11.42                  | 20.38            | 77.58               | 386.1             |
|          | smoothness_mean         | compactness_mean       | concavity_mean   | concave.points_mean |                   |
| 842302   | 0.11840                 | 0.27760                | 0.3001           |                     | 0.14710           |
| 842517   | 0.08474                 | 0.07864                | 0.0869           |                     | 0.07017           |
| 84300903 | 0.10960                 | 0.15990                | 0.1974           |                     | 0.12790           |
| 84348301 | 0.14250                 | 0.28390                | 0.2414           |                     | 0.10520           |
|          | symmetry_mean           | fractal_dimension_mean | radius_se        | texture_se          | perimeter_se      |
| 842302   | 0.2419                  | 0.07871                | 1.0950           | 0.9053              | 8.589             |
| 842517   | 0.1812                  | 0.05667                | 0.5435           | 0.7339              | 3.398             |
| 84300903 | 0.2069                  | 0.05999                | 0.7456           | 0.7869              | 4.585             |
| 84348301 | 0.2597                  | 0.09744                | 0.4956           | 1.1560              | 3.445             |
|          | area_se                 | smoothness_se          | compactness_se   | concavity_se        | concave.points_se |
| 842302   | 153.40                  | 0.006399               | 0.04904          | 0.05373             | 0.01587           |
| 842517   | 74.08                   | 0.005225               | 0.01308          | 0.01860             | 0.01340           |
| 84300903 | 94.03                   | 0.006150               | 0.04006          | 0.03832             | 0.02058           |
| 84348301 | 27.23                   | 0.009110               | 0.07458          | 0.05661             | 0.01867           |
|          | symmetry_se             | fractal_dimension_se   | radius_worst     | texture_worst       |                   |
| 842302   | 0.03003                 | 0.006193               | 25.38            | 17.33               |                   |
| 842517   | 0.01389                 | 0.003532               | 24.99            | 23.41               |                   |
| 84300903 | 0.02250                 | 0.004571               | 23.57            | 25.53               |                   |
| 84348301 | 0.05963                 | 0.009208               | 14.91            | 26.50               |                   |
|          | perimeter_worst         | area_worst             | smoothness_worst | compactness_worst   |                   |
| 842302   | 184.60                  | 2019.0                 | 0.1622           | 0.6656              |                   |
| 842517   | 158.80                  | 1956.0                 | 0.1238           | 0.1866              |                   |
| 84300903 | 152.50                  | 1709.0                 | 0.1444           | 0.4245              |                   |
| 84348301 | 98.87                   | 567.7                  | 0.2098           | 0.8663              |                   |
|          | concavity_worst         | concave.points_worst   | symmetry_worst   |                     |                   |
| 842302   | 0.7119                  | 0.2654                 | 0.4601           |                     |                   |
| 842517   | 0.2416                  | 0.1860                 | 0.2750           |                     |                   |
| 84300903 | 0.4504                  | 0.2430                 | 0.3613           |                     |                   |
| 84348301 | 0.6869                  | 0.2575                 | 0.6638           |                     |                   |
|          | fractal_dimension_worst |                        |                  |                     |                   |
| 842302   | 0.11890                 |                        |                  |                     |                   |
| 842517   | 0.08902                 |                        |                  |                     |                   |
| 84300903 | 0.08758                 |                        |                  |                     |                   |
| 84348301 | 0.17300                 |                        |                  |                     |                   |

Drop the expert `diagnosis` column so we don't accidentally use it during the unsupervised analysis, and save it separately as a factor for later checks.

```
wisc.data <- wisc.df[, -1]  
diagnosis <- as.factor(wisc.df$diagnosis)
```

**Q1. How many observations are in this dataset?**

```
nrow(wisc.data)
```

```
[1] 569
```

**Answer:** There are **569 observations** in the dataset.

**Q2. How many of the observations have a malignant diagnosis?**

```
table(diagnosis)
```

```
diagnosis  
  B    M  
357 212
```

```
sum(diagnosis == "M")
```

```
[1] 212
```

**Answer:** **212** of the **569 observations** have a malignant (M) diagnosis (the remaining 357 are benign).

**Q3. How many variables/features in the data are suffixed with \_mean?**

```
length(grep("_mean$", colnames(wisc.data)))
```

```
[1] 10
```

**Answer:** **10 features** are suffixed with **\_mean** (one per measurement type: radius\_mean, texture\_mean, perimeter\_mean, area\_mean, smoothness\_mean, compactness\_mean, concavity\_mean, concave.points\_mean, symmetry\_mean, fractal\_dimension\_mean).

# Principal Component Analysis

## Performing PCA

Check whether we need to scale, features have very different means/variances, so yes.

```
round(colMeans(wisc.data), 3)
```

|                        |                      |                         |
|------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------|
| radius_mean            | texture_mean         | perimeter_mean          |
| 14.127                 | 19.290               | 91.969                  |
| area_mean              | smoothness_mean      | compactness_mean        |
| 654.889                | 0.096                | 0.104                   |
| concavity_mean         | concave.points_mean  | symmetry_mean           |
| 0.089                  | 0.049                | 0.181                   |
| fractal_dimension_mean | radius_se            | texture_se              |
| 0.063                  | 0.405                | 1.217                   |
| perimeter_se           | area_se              | smoothness_se           |
| 2.866                  | 40.337               | 0.007                   |
| compactness_se         | concavity_se         | concave.points_se       |
| 0.025                  | 0.032                | 0.012                   |
| symmetry_se            | fractal_dimension_se | radius_worst            |
| 0.021                  | 0.004                | 16.269                  |
| texture_worst          | perimeter_worst      | area_worst              |
| 25.677                 | 107.261              | 880.583                 |
| smoothness_worst       | compactness_worst    | concavity_worst         |
| 0.132                  | 0.254                | 0.272                   |
| concave.points_worst   | symmetry_worst       | fractal_dimension_worst |
| 0.115                  | 0.290                | 0.084                   |

```
round(apply(wisc.data, 2, sd), 3)
```

|                        |                     |                  |
|------------------------|---------------------|------------------|
| radius_mean            | texture_mean        | perimeter_mean   |
| 3.524                  | 4.301               | 24.299           |
| area_mean              | smoothness_mean     | compactness_mean |
| 351.914                | 0.014               | 0.053            |
| concavity_mean         | concave.points_mean | symmetry_mean    |
| 0.080                  | 0.039               | 0.027            |
| fractal_dimension_mean | radius_se           | texture_se       |
| 0.007                  | 0.277               | 0.552            |
| perimeter_se           | area_se             | smoothness_se    |
| 2.022                  | 45.491              | 0.003            |

|                      |                      |                         |
|----------------------|----------------------|-------------------------|
| compactness_se       | concavity_se         | concave.points_se       |
| 0.018                | 0.030                | 0.006                   |
| symmetry_se          | fractal_dimension_se | radius_worst            |
| 0.008                | 0.003                | 4.833                   |
| texture_worst        | perimeter_worst      | area_worst              |
| 6.146                | 33.603               | 569.357                 |
| smoothness_worst     | compactness_worst    | concavity_worst         |
| 0.023                | 0.157                | 0.209                   |
| concave.points_worst | symmetry_worst       | fractal_dimension_worst |
| 0.066                | 0.062                | 0.018                   |

```
wisc.pr <- prcomp(wisc.data, scale = TRUE)
summary(wisc.pr)
```

Importance of components:

|                        | PC1     | PC2     | PC3     | PC4     | PC5     | PC6     | PC7     |
|------------------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
| Standard deviation     | 3.6444  | 2.3857  | 1.67867 | 1.40735 | 1.28403 | 1.09880 | 0.82172 |
| Proportion of Variance | 0.4427  | 0.1897  | 0.09393 | 0.06602 | 0.05496 | 0.04025 | 0.02251 |
| Cumulative Proportion  | 0.4427  | 0.6324  | 0.72636 | 0.79239 | 0.84734 | 0.88759 | 0.91010 |
|                        | PC8     | PC9     | PC10    | PC11    | PC12    | PC13    | PC14    |
| Standard deviation     | 0.69037 | 0.6457  | 0.59219 | 0.5421  | 0.51104 | 0.49128 | 0.39624 |
| Proportion of Variance | 0.01589 | 0.0139  | 0.01169 | 0.0098  | 0.00871 | 0.00805 | 0.00523 |
| Cumulative Proportion  | 0.92598 | 0.9399  | 0.95157 | 0.9614  | 0.97007 | 0.97812 | 0.98335 |
|                        | PC15    | PC16    | PC17    | PC18    | PC19    | PC20    | PC21    |
| Standard deviation     | 0.30681 | 0.28260 | 0.24372 | 0.22939 | 0.22244 | 0.17652 | 0.1731  |
| Proportion of Variance | 0.00314 | 0.00266 | 0.00198 | 0.00175 | 0.00165 | 0.00104 | 0.0010  |
| Cumulative Proportion  | 0.98649 | 0.98915 | 0.99113 | 0.99288 | 0.99453 | 0.99557 | 0.9966  |
|                        | PC22    | PC23    | PC24    | PC25    | PC26    | PC27    | PC28    |
| Standard deviation     | 0.16565 | 0.15602 | 0.1344  | 0.12442 | 0.09043 | 0.08307 | 0.03987 |
| Proportion of Variance | 0.00091 | 0.00081 | 0.0006  | 0.00052 | 0.00027 | 0.00023 | 0.00005 |
| Cumulative Proportion  | 0.99749 | 0.99830 | 0.9989  | 0.99942 | 0.99969 | 0.99992 | 0.99997 |
|                        | PC29    | PC30    |         |         |         |         |         |
| Standard deviation     | 0.02736 | 0.01153 |         |         |         |         |         |
| Proportion of Variance | 0.00002 | 0.00000 |         |         |         |         |         |
| Cumulative Proportion  | 1.00000 | 1.00000 |         |         |         |         |         |

#### Q4. Proportion of variance captured by PC1?

**Answer:** PC1 captures **44.27%** of the total variance (0.4427).

**Q5. How many PCs are required to describe at least 70% of the variance?**

**Answer: 3 PCs**, the cumulative proportion reaches 72.64% at PC3 (PC1 + PC2 + PC3 = 44.27% + 18.97% + 9.39%).

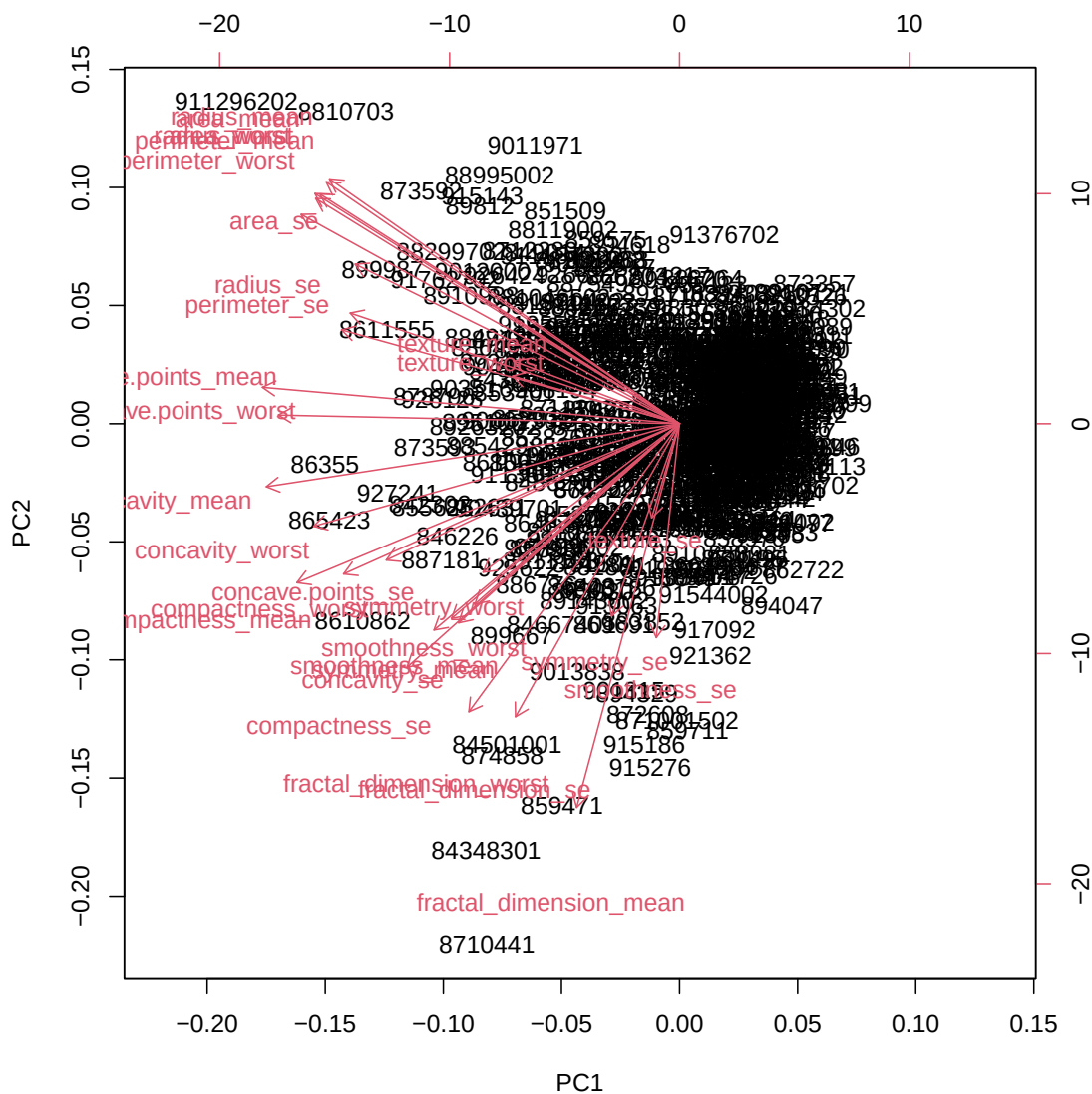
**Q6. How many PCs are required to describe at least 90% of the variance?**

**Answer: 7 PCs**, the cumulative proportion reaches 91.01% at PC7.

### **Interpreting PCA results**

A biplot is typically hard to read for data of this size:

```
biplot(wisc.pr)
```

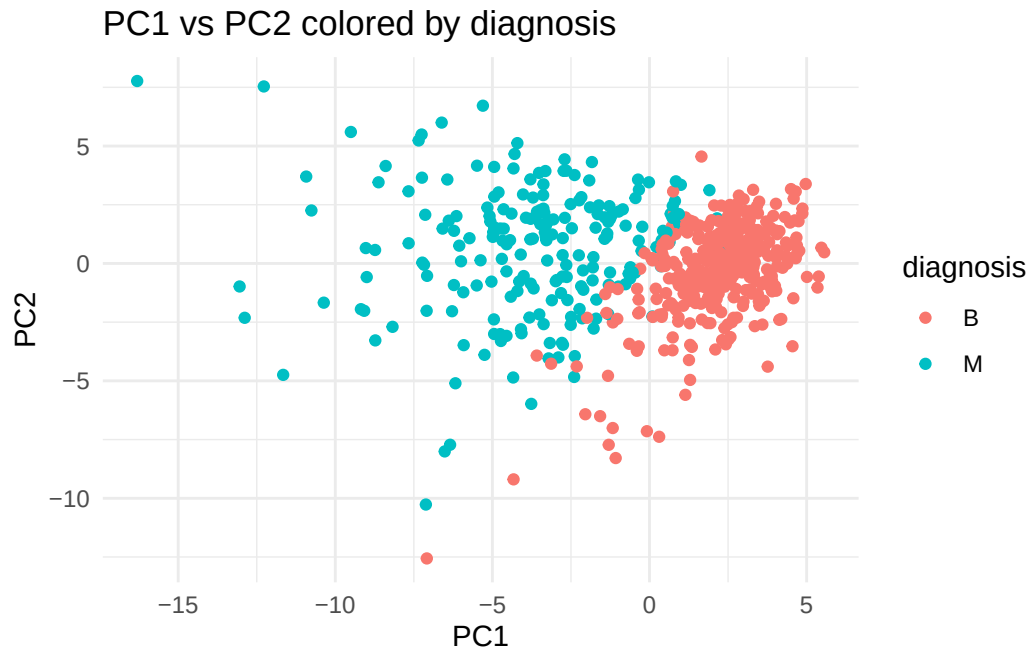


**Q7. What stands out in the biplot? Is it easy or difficult to understand?**

**Answer:** It is **very difficult to understand**. With 569 observations `biplot()` uses the row names (patient IDs) as the plotting symbol, so the samples overlap into a dense blob, and all 30 feature-loading arrows fan out on top of them. There is no obvious grouping visible, and the patient IDs carry no biological meaning. A clean PC1-vs-PC2 scatter plot colored by diagnosis (below) is far more informative.

A much cleaner PC1 vs PC2 scatter plot, colored by diagnosis:

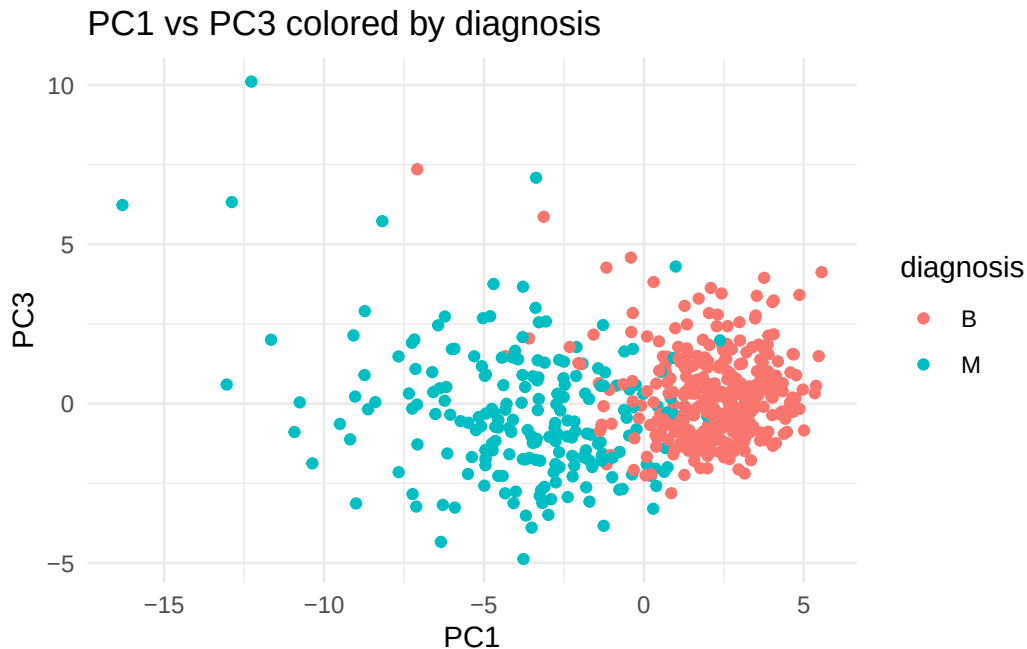
```
library(ggplot2)
ggplot(as.data.frame(wisc.pr$x)) +
  aes(PC1, PC2, col = diagnosis) +
  geom_point() +
  theme_minimal() +
  labs(title = "PC1 vs PC2 colored by diagnosis")
```



**Q8. Generate a similar plot for PC1 vs PC3. What do you notice?**

```
ggplot(as.data.frame(wisc.pr$x)) +
  aes(PC1, PC3, col = diagnosis) +
  geom_point() +
  theme_minimal() +
  labs(title = "PC1 vs PC3 colored by diagnosis")
```



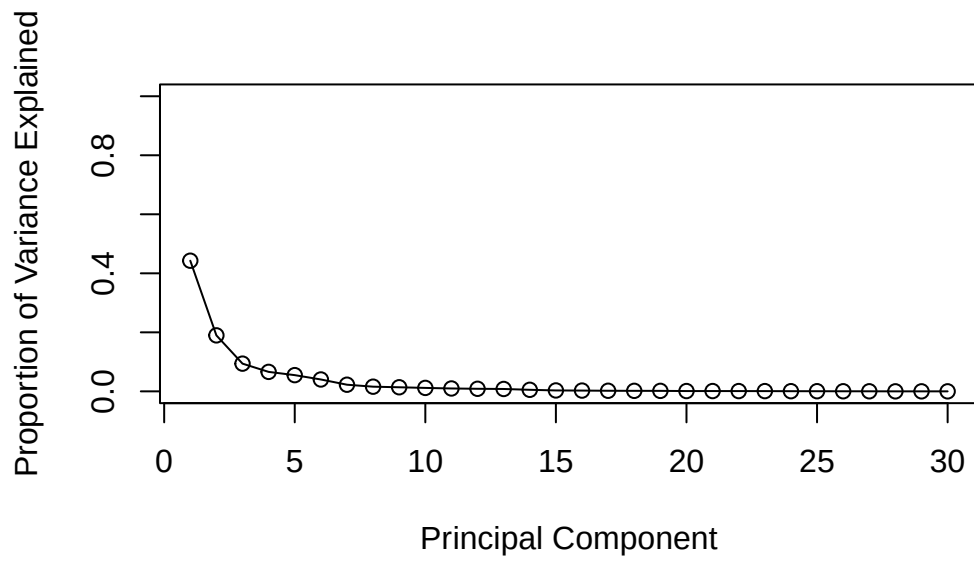


**Answer:** The PC1-vs-PC3 plot looks similar to PC1-vs-PC2 in that **PC1 still cleanly separates malignant from benign** samples along the x-axis. However, PC3 explains less variance (9.4%) than PC2 (19.0%), so the two groups are *slightly* less separated in the y-direction, the points are more vertically mixed than in PC1-vs-PC2. This confirms that most of the M/B signal is concentrated in PC1, with PC2 contributing more than PC3.

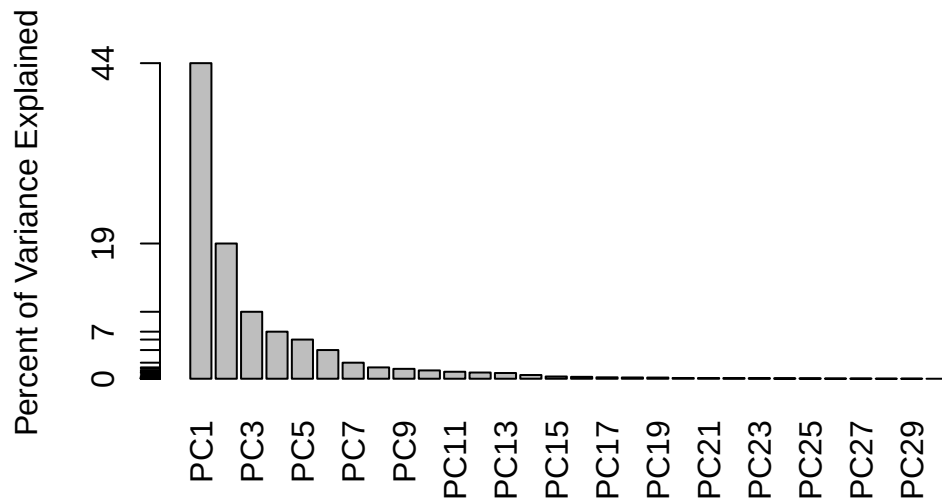
## Variance explained

```
pr.var <- wisc.pr$sdev^2
pve    <- pr.var / sum(pr.var)

plot(pve, xlab = "Principal Component",
     ylab = "Proportion of Variance Explained",
     ylim = c(0, 1), type = "o")
```

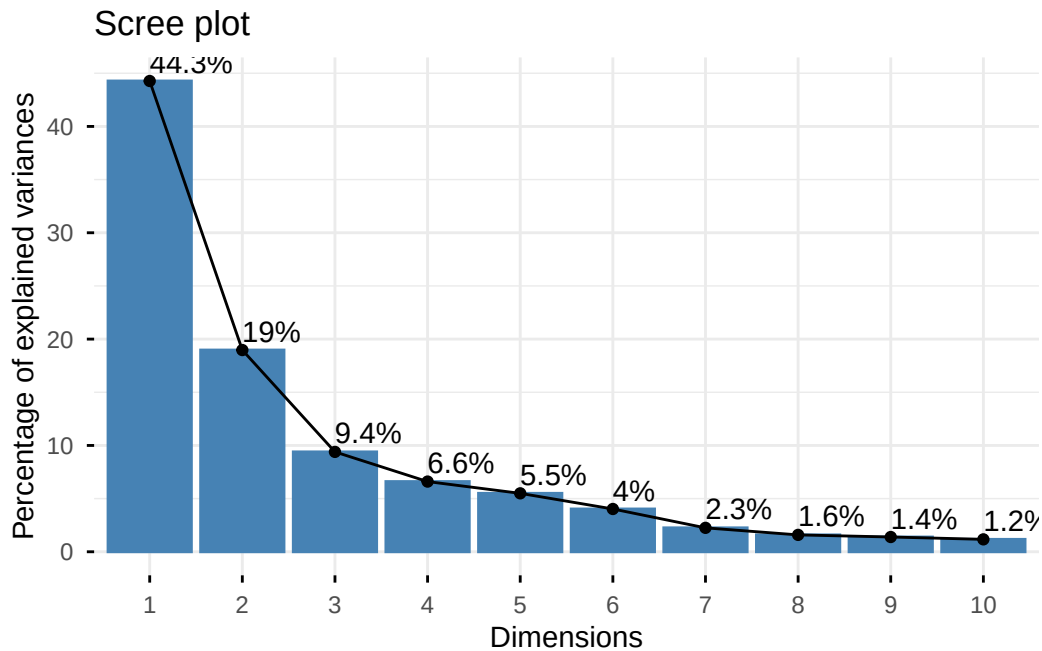


```
barplot(pve, ylab = "Percent of Variance Explained",
        names.arg = paste0("PC", 1:length(pve)), las = 2, axes = FALSE)
axis(2, at = pve, labels = round(pve, 2) * 100)
```



Optional: a nicer scree plot with factoextra.

```
library(factoextra)
fviz_eig(wisc.pr, addlabels = TRUE)
```



**Q9. PC1 loading for concave.points\_mean? Any larger contributions?**

```
wisc.pr$rotation["concave.points_mean", 1]
```

```
[1] -0.2608538
```

```
sort(abs(wisc.pr$rotation[, 1]), decreasing = TRUE) |> head(10)
```

|                     |                 |                      |
|---------------------|-----------------|----------------------|
| concave.points_mean | concavity_mean  | concave.points_worst |
| 0.2608538           | 0.2584005       | 0.2508860            |
| compactness_mean    | perimeter_worst | concavity_worst      |
| 0.2392854           | 0.2366397       | 0.2287675            |
| radius_worst        | perimeter_mean  | area_worst           |
| 0.2279966           | 0.2275373       | 0.2248705            |
| area_mean           |                 |                      |
| 0.2209950           |                 |                      |

**Answer:** The PC1 loading for `concave.points_mean` is **−0.2609**. Its absolute value (0.2609) is the **largest** of any feature on PC1, no feature contributes more to PC1. The next-largest are `concavity_mean` (0.2584), `concave.points_worst` (0.2509), and `compactness_mean` (0.2393), so the dominant drivers of PC1 are the concavity and compactness measurements, which makes biological sense: malignant cell nuclei tend to have more irregular, concave contours.

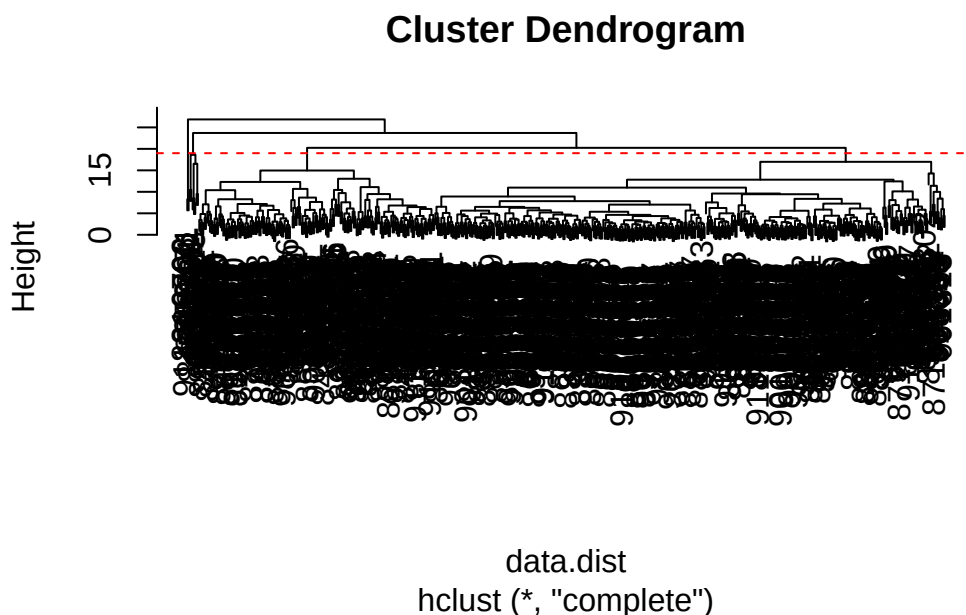
## Hierarchical clustering

Hierarchical clustering on the original (scaled) 30 features.

```
data.scaled <- scale(wisc.data)
data.dist   <- dist(data.scaled)
wisc.hclust <- hclust(data.dist, method = "complete")
```

**Q10. Height at which the model has 4 clusters?**

```
plot(wisc.hclust)
abline(h = 19, col = "red", lty = 2) # adjust height so the dashed line cuts into exactly 4
```



**Answer:** The 4-cluster cut occurs at a **height of 19** (any height between 18.64 and 20.24 cuts the dendrogram into exactly 4 clusters; using  $h = 19$  gives 4 clusters).

### Selecting number of clusters

```
wisc.hclust.clusters <- cutree(wisc.hclust, k = 4)
table(wisc.hclust.clusters, diagnosis)
```

|                      | diagnosis |     |  |
|----------------------|-----------|-----|--|
| wisc.hclust.clusters | B         | M   |  |
| 1                    | 12        | 165 |  |
| 2                    | 2         | 5   |  |
| 3                    | 343       | 40  |  |
| 4                    | 0         | 2   |  |

### Q11. (OPTIONAL) Better cluster-vs-diagnoses match with k between 2 and 6?

```
for (k in 2:6) {
  cat("\n--- k =", k, "----\n")
  print(table(cutree(wisc.hclust, k = k), diagnosis))
}
```

```
--- k = 2 ---
  diagnosis
    B    M
  1 357 210
  2   0   2
```

```
--- k = 3 ---
  diagnosis
    B    M
  1 355 205
  2   2   5
  3   0   2
```

```
--- k = 4 ---
```

```

      diagnosis
        B   M
1   12 165
2    2   5
3 343  40
4    0   2

--- k = 5 ---
      diagnosis
        B   M
1   12 165
2    0   5
3 343  40
4    2   0
5    0   2

--- k = 6 ---
      diagnosis
        B   M
1   12 165
2    0   5
3 331  39
4    2   0
5   12   1
6    0   2

```

**Answer (optional):** No, I could not find a clearly better split. With **complete linkage**, increasing  $k$  mostly produces tiny fragmented clusters rather than cleaner M/B separation. At  $k = 2$  and  $k = 3$  nearly everything is dumped into one big cluster (357 B + 210 M together), which is useless. At  $k = 4$  we finally get a useful split, cluster 1 is M-dominant (12 B, 165 M) and cluster 3 is B-dominant (343 B, 40 M). At  $k = 5$  and  $k = 6$  the B-dominant cluster starts splintering without improving the M/B boundary, so  $k = 4$  remains the best complete-linkage result.

## Q12. Which linkage method gives your favorite results?

```

for (m in c("single", "complete", "average", "ward.D2")) {
  cat("\n--- method =", m, "---\n")
  h <- hclust(data.dist, method = m)
  print(table(cutree(h, k = 2), diagnosis))
}

```

```

--- method = single ---
  diagnosis
    B   M
1 357 210
2   0   2

--- method = complete ---
  diagnosis
    B   M
1 357 210
2   0   2

--- method = average ---
  diagnosis
    B   M
1 357 209
2   0   3

--- method = ward.D2 ---
  diagnosis
    B   M
1  20 164
2 337  48

```

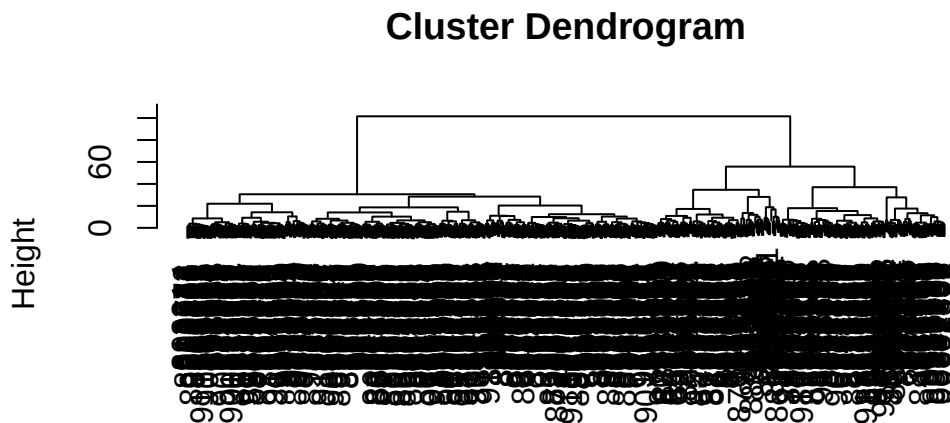
**Answer: ward.D2 is my favorite.** At  $k = 2$ , single, complete, and average linkage all collapse the data into one giant cluster (357 B + 210 M together) plus a tiny outlier group of 2–3 points, they fail to separate malignant from benign at all. ward.D2 is the only method that produces two **balanced, biologically meaningful** clusters at  $k = 2$ : cluster 1 is M-dominant (20 B, 164 M) and cluster 2 is B-dominant (337 B, 48 M). This is because Ward’s method minimizes within-cluster variance at each merge, which is well-suited to data like this where the groups are roughly spherical in the scaled feature space.

## Combining methods

### Clustering on PCA results

Use the minimum number of PCs required to explain at least 90% of the variance (from Q6, typically the first 7 PCs).

```
wisc.pr.hclust <- hclust(dist(wisc.pr$x[, 1:7]), method = "ward.D2")
plot(wisc.pr.hclust)
```



```
dist(wisc.pr$x[, 1:7])
hclust (*, "ward.D2")
```

```
grps <- cutree(wisc.pr.hclust, k = 2)
table(grps)
```

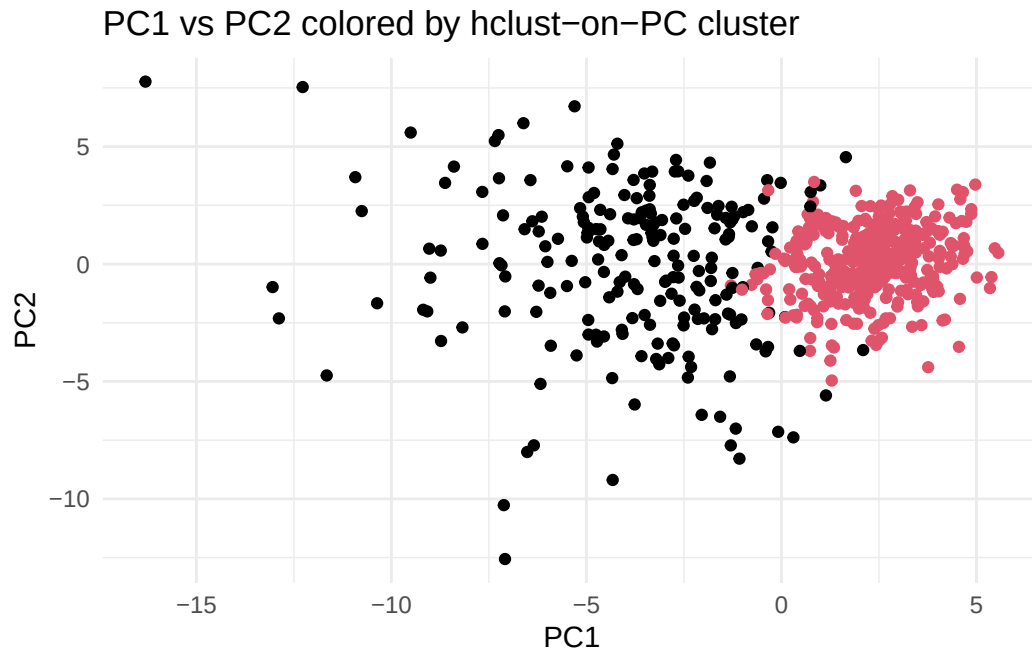
```
grps
  1  2
216 353
```

```
table(grps, diagnosis)
```

```
      diagnosis
grps   B    M
  1   28 188
  2  329   24
```

```
ggplot(as.data.frame(wisc.pr$x)) +
  aes(PC1, PC2) +
  geom_point(col = grps) +
  theme_minimal() +
  labs(title = "PC1 vs PC2 colored by hclust-on-PC cluster")
```





```
wisc.pr.hclust.clusters <- cutree(wisc.pr.hclust, k = 2)
```

**Q13. How well does the new hclust model (on PCs) with 2 clusters separate M and B?**

```
table(wisc.pr.hclust.clusters, diagnosis)
```

|                         | diagnosis |     |
|-------------------------|-----------|-----|
| wisc.pr.hclust.clusters | B         | M   |
| 1                       | 28        | 188 |
| 2                       | 329       | 24  |

**Answer:** The two-cluster model on the first 7 PCs separates the diagnoses **very well**. Cluster 1 contains 28 B and **188 M** (largely malignant), and cluster 2 contains **329 B** and 24 M (largely benign). That means 188 of 212 malignant samples (88.7%) and 329 of 357 benign samples (92.2%) are correctly grouped, a clean, balanced split with only about 52 misclassifications out of 569 total.

#### Q14. How well did the earlier hclust (no PCA) do?

```
table(wisc.hclust.clusters, diagnosis)
```

|                      | diagnosis |     |
|----------------------|-----------|-----|
| wisc.hclust.clusters | B         | M   |
| 1                    | 12        | 165 |
| 2                    | 2         | 5   |
| 3                    | 343       | 40  |
| 4                    | 0         | 2   |

**Answer:** The original hclust on the 30 scaled features (complete linkage,  $k = 4$ ) does a **decent but messier** job. Cluster 1 is strongly malignant (12 B, 165 M) and cluster 3 is strongly benign (343 B, 40 M), but the clean signal is spread across 4 clusters (with two tiny side clusters containing 7 and 2 points). The **PCA + ward.D2 model is noticeably cleaner**, it achieves a similar M/B separation using only 2 clusters, captures more of the malignant samples (188 M vs 165 M in the M-dominant cluster), and produces a result that is easier to interpret and evaluate.

### Sensitivity / Specificity

Given:

- **Sensitivity** =  $TP / (TP + FN)$ , a fraction of true malignant samples captured by the cluster dominated by M.
- **Specificity** =  $TN / (TN + FP)$ , a fraction of true benign samples captured by the cluster dominated by B.

#### Q15. (OPTIONAL) Which procedure gave the best specificity? Sensitivity?

```
sens_spec <- function(tbl) {  
  mc <- which.max(tbl[, "M"])  
  bc <- which.max(tbl[, "B"])  
  TP <- tbl[mc, "M"]; FN <- sum(tbl[, "M"]) - TP  
  TN <- tbl[bc, "B"]; FP <- sum(tbl[, "B"]) - TN  
  c(sensitivity = TP / (TP + FN), specificity = TN / (TN + FP))  
}
```

```
res <- rbind(
  `PCA + hclust (ward.D2, k=2)` = sens_spec(table(wisc.pr.hclust.clusters, diagnosis)),
  `hclust (complete, k=4)`      = sens_spec(table(wisc.hclust.clusters, diagnosis))
)
round(res, 4)
```

|                             | sensitivity | specificity |
|-----------------------------|-------------|-------------|
| PCA + hclust (ward.D2, k=2) | 0.8868      | 0.9216      |
| hclust (complete, k=4)      | 0.7783      | 0.9608      |

### Answer (optional):

- **Best sensitivity:** PCA + hclust (sensitivity **0.887** vs 0.778 for the raw-feature hclust). It recovers 188 / 212 malignant samples.
- **Best specificity:** hclust (complete, k=4) (specificity **0.961** vs 0.922 for PCA + hclust). Its B-dominant cluster 3 has only 40 M out of 383 samples.

In a cancer-screening context sensitivity is usually the more important metric (missing a malignant tumor is far worse than a false alarm), so **PCA + hclust is the preferred model overall**.

## Prediction

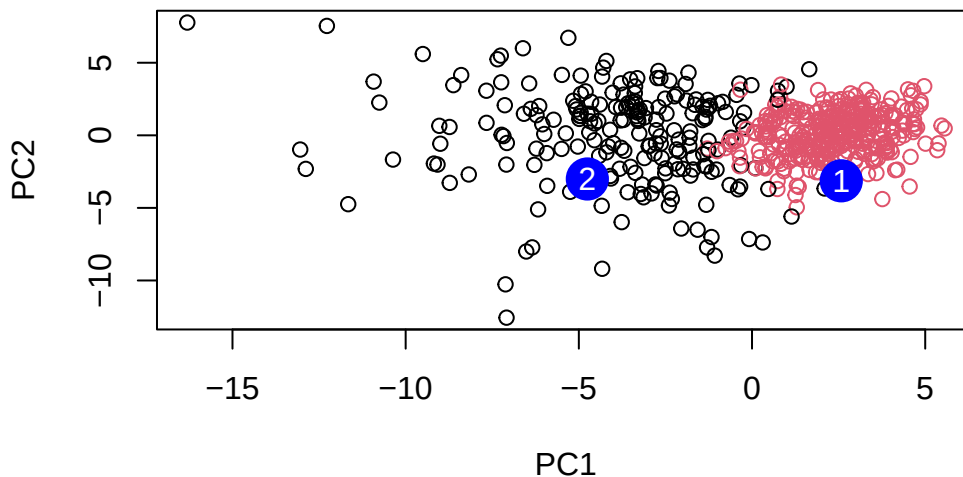
Project two new patient samples onto the existing PCA space.

```
url <- "https://tinyurl.com/new-samples-CSV"
new <- read.csv(url)
npc <- predict(wisc.pr, newdata = new)
npc
```

|      | PC1        | PC2        | PC3         | PC4         | PC5         | PC6        | PC7        |
|------|------------|------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|------------|------------|
| [1,] | 2.576616   | -3.135913  | 1.3990492   | -0.7631950  | 2.781648    | -0.8150185 | -0.3959098 |
| [2,] | -4.754928  | -3.009033  | -0.1660946  | -0.6052952  | -1.140698   | -1.2189945 | 0.8193031  |
|      | PC8        | PC9        | PC10        | PC11        | PC12        | PC13       | PC14       |
| [1,] | -0.2307350 | 0.1029569  | -0.9272861  | 0.3411457   | 0.375921    | 0.1610764  | 1.187882   |
| [2,] | -0.3307423 | 0.5281896  | -0.4855301  | 0.7173233   | -1.185917   | 0.5893856  | 0.303029   |
|      | PC15       | PC16       | PC17        | PC18        | PC19        | PC20       |            |
| [1,] | 0.3216974  | -0.1743616 | -0.07875393 | -0.11207028 | -0.08802955 | -0.2495216 |            |
| [2,] | 0.1299153  | 0.1448061  | -0.40509706 | 0.06565549  | 0.25591230  | -0.4289500 |            |
|      | PC21       | PC22       | PC23        | PC24        | PC25        | PC26       |            |

```
[1,] 0.1228233 0.09358453 0.08347651 0.1223396 0.02124121 0.078884581
[2,] -0.1224776 0.01732146 0.06316631 -0.2338618 -0.20755948 -0.009833238
      PC27      PC28      PC29      PC30
[1,] 0.220199544 -0.02946023 -0.015620933 0.005269029
[2,] -0.001134152 0.09638361 0.002795349 -0.019015820
```

```
plot(wisc.pr$x[, 1:2], col = grps)
points(npc[, 1], npc[, 2], col = "blue", pch = 16, cex = 3)
text(npc[, 1], npc[, 2], c(1, 2), col = "white")
```



#### Q16. Which of these new patients should we prioritize for follow-up?

**Answer:** We should prioritize **Patient 1**. On the PC1-vs-PC2 plot, patient 1 lands at (PC1 = +2.58, PC2 = -3.14), which falls inside the **malignant-dominated cluster** (the right-hand/positive-PC1 group in our PCA + hclust model). Patient 2 lands at (PC1 = -4.75, PC2 = -3.01), clearly inside the benign-dominated cluster on the left. Since PC1 is the main axis separating malignant from benign, patient 1's large positive PC1 score flags them as needing follow-up, while patient 2's profile is consistent with benign samples.

## Session info

```
sessionInfo()
```

```
R version 4.4.3 (2025-02-28)
Platform: aarch64-apple-darwin20
Running under: macOS Sequoia 15.5
```

```
Matrix products: default
```

```
BLAS: /Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.4-arm64/Resources/lib/libRblas.0.dylib
```

```
LAPACK: /Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.4-arm64/Resources/lib/libRlapack.dylib; I
```

```
locale:
```

```
[1] en_US.UTF-8/en_US.UTF-8/en_US.UTF-8/C/en_US.UTF-8/en_US.UTF-8
```

```
time zone: America/Los_Angeles
```

```
tzcode source: internal
```

```
attached base packages:
```

```
[1] stats      graphics  grDevices  utils      datasets  methods    base
```

```
other attached packages:
```

```
[1] factoextra_2.0.0 ggplot2_4.0.2
```

```
loaded via a namespace (and not attached):
```

|                      |                  |                    |                |
|----------------------|------------------|--------------------|----------------|
| [1] gtable_0.3.6     | jsonlite_2.0.0   | dplyr_1.2.0        | compiler_4.4.3 |
| [5] ggsignif_0.6.4   | tidyselect_1.2.1 | Rcpp_1.1.1         | tidyr_1.3.2    |
| [9] scales_1.4.0     | yaml_2.3.12      | fastmap_1.2.0      | R6_2.6.1       |
| [13] ggpubr_0.6.3    | labeling_0.4.3   | generics_0.1.4     | Formula_1.2-5  |
| [17] knitr_1.51      | backports_1.5.0  | ggrepel_0.9.8      | tibble_3.3.1   |
| [21] car_3.1-5       | pillar_1.11.1    | RColorBrewer_1.1-3 | rlang_1.1.7    |
| [25] broom_1.0.12    | xfun_0.57        | S7_0.2.1           | otel_0.2.0     |
| [29] cli_3.6.5       | withr_3.0.2      | magrittr_2.0.4     | digest_0.6.39  |
| [33] grid_4.4.3      | lifecycle_1.0.5  | vctrs_0.7.2        | rstatix_0.7.3  |
| [37] evaluate_1.0.5  | glue_1.8.0       | farver_2.1.2       | abind_1.4-8    |
| [41] carData_3.0-6   | rmarkdown_2.30   | purrr_1.2.1        | tools_4.4.3    |
| [45] pkgconfig_2.0.3 | htmltools_0.5.9  |                    |                |